Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 6
♥ K Q 10 8 3 2
♦ A 7
♣ A K 3

♠ A 8 5 2
♥ 7
♦ J 9 4
♣ Q J 8 7 4

♠ 10 9 7 4
♥ A 5
♦ K Q 10 5 3
♣ 10 2

♠ K Q 3
♥ J 9 6 4
♦ 8 6 2
♣ 9 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦K

SOUTH's 2♥ raise shows 6-10 points and a least three trumps.

NORTH, with 19+ points, decides that game is almost a certainty and bids 4♥.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 8 6 3
♥ J 7 5 4
♦ A 8
♣ 5 3 2

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 9 6
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 8 4

♠ A Q 4
♥ K 10 8
♦ J 10 9 5
♣ A J 6

♠ K 5 2
♥ Q 3 2
♦ 6 4 2
♣ Q 10 9 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♥3

EAST has an ideal 1NT opening - 15 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, WEST knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game but not enough to think about slam. Since WEST has no 4-card Major suit she bids 3NT.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 6 4
♥ A 9 5
♦ 8 2
♣ A K 6 3

♠ A 9 2
♥ Q 10 4 3
♦ A J 3
♣ J 9 4

♠ 8 5
♥ J 8 7 2
♦ K Q 9 6
♣ Q 10 7

♠ K 10 7 3
♥ K 6
♦ 10 7 5 4
♣ 8 5 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by South
Lead: ♥4

With 6 points, SOUTH must respond to NORTH's 1♣ opening bid. While it is often correct to respond by bidding suits "up-the-line", SOUTH should skip over the weak ♦ suit in favor of showing the 4-card Major ♠ suit.

NORTH knows that SOUTH may only have four ♠s, but with four of her own she can support the suit. Since she has a minimum opening bid she merely raises to 2♠. With his minimum response hand SOUTH passes.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A 10 4 3 ♥ J 5 ♦ Q J 7 ♣ Q 10 7 3	
♠ Q J 6 ♥ A K Q 7 2 ♦ A 5 3 ♣ 6 4		♠ 7 5 ♥ 10 9 8 4 ♦ K 9 4 ♣ K 8 5 2
	♠ K 9 8 2 ♥ 6 3 ♦ 10 8 6 2 ♣ A J 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥			
All Pass			

3♥ by West
Lead: ♣7

With 17 points WEST is not strong enough to insist on game after EAST's raise, but is strong enough to invite with a 3♥ bid.

EAST, however, doesn't have anything extra, so declines to go further.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 8 3 2 ♥ K 10 9 ♦ A J 7 ♣ K Q 6	
♠ Q 5 ♥ 6 5 3 2 ♦ 10 4 3 ♣ A 7 4 3		♠ K J 7 6 ♥ A 8 7 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ 10 8 2
	♠ 10 9 4 ♥ Q J 4 ♦ K Q 5 2 ♣ J 9 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♦9

This is a classic Notrump bidding sequence.

NORTH opens 1NT with 17 points and balanced distribution. SOUTH, with 9 points is not strong enough to bid game, but invites with 2NT. NORTH has a maximum, so she accepts the invitation.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 9 7 5 3 ♥ 10 9 8 ♦ K Q 9 3 ♣ J 5	
♠ K J 8 4 ♥ A K 7 2 ♦ 6 5 ♣ K 9 3		♠ A Q 10 6 ♥ 5 4 ♦ A 8 7 4 ♣ A 8 2
	♠ 2 ♥ Q J 6 3 ♦ J 10 2 ♣ Q 10 7 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♦	Pass
1♥	Pass	1♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♠2

With two 4-card Majors WEST should respond "up-the-line", bidding ♥s first.

Then, after EAST bids 1♠, WEST has enough points to jump all the way to 4♠.

Board 7
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A 9 6 3 ♥ Q 6 4 ♦ A 9 6 2 ♣ J 7	
♠ 2 ♥ J 10 5 2 ♦ J 8 7 3 ♣ 9 8 5 3	N W E S	♠ J 7 5 ♥ K 9 8 3 ♦ 10 4 ♣ A K 4 2
	♠ K Q 10 8 4 ♥ A 7 ♦ K Q 5 ♣ Q 10 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣5

SOUTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1♠.

NORTH has excellent ♠ support but with 11 points is not quite strong enough to insist on reaching game. Instead he makes an invitational jump to 3♠, which SOUTH is strong enough to raise to game.

Board 8
West Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 9 3
♥ K Q 7 5 2
♦ 5 3
♣ Q 6 4

♠ A K 6
♥ A J 9
♦ A J 2
♣ A 8 5 2

♠ 8 7
♥ 10 6 4
♦ K Q 10 9 6
♣ 10 7 3

♠ Q J 5 4 2
♥ 8 3
♦ 8 7 4
♣ K J 9

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♥K

WEST has a powerful hand, but 21 points is not strong enough to start with a forcing 2♣ bid. Since he has balanced distribution he opens 2NT (20-21 points).

EAST adds her 6 points to WEST's minimum and concludes they should be in game. She expects her good ♦ suit to be useful to EAST in Notrump so she bids 3NT.

Board 9
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 10 9 5 ♥ J 4 ♦ Q J 8 3 ♣ K J 7 2	
♠ A 4 2 ♥ 10 7 6 5 3 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ A 3	N W E S	♠ K Q 8 7 ♥ 9 ♦ A 9 5 4 ♣ Q 8 6 4
	♠ J 6 3 ♥ A K Q 8 2 ♦ K 6 ♣ 10 9 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			

1NT by North
Lead: ♠7

SOUTH has a solid 1♥ opening, 14 points and five trumps.

NORTH must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least 11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

SOUTH doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

Board 10
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 5 ♥ J 10 9 3 ♦ A 10 6 2 ♣ K J 8 3	
♠ J 9 6 2 ♥ K Q 7 5 ♦ 8 3 ♣ 10 7 4		♠ K Q 10 7 3 ♥ A 4 2 ♦ 9 7 5 ♣ A 6
	♠ A 8 4 ♥ 8 6 ♦ K Q J 4 ♣ Q 9 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2♠			
All Pass			

2♠ by East
Lead: ♥8

EAST has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

WEST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠, passed by EAST.

WEST does not consider showing the ♥s, first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.

Board 11
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J 4 ♥ K Q 9 2 ♦ A Q 5 ♣ K 10 8	
♠ Q 10 9 7 6 5 ♥ 6 3 ♦ 8 ♣ 7 6 3 2	N W E S	♠ 2 ♥ J 10 8 5 4 ♦ 10 7 3 2 ♣ A 9 4
	♠ A 8 3 ♥ A 7 ♦ K J 9 6 4 ♣ Q J 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♠10

With balanced distribution and 16 points SOUTH should open 1NT rather than 1♦.

NORTH's response is based on simple math. He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that SOUTH has announced and comes up with 33 points combined. This is enough for a small slam, and since he has balanced distribution he bids 6NT.

Board 12
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ K 8 5 4 3
♦ K J 4
♣ 10 6 4

♠ K 4
♥ Q 10 6
♦ 8 5 3 2
♣ Q 9 8 5

♠ Q J 10 9 6
♥ A 7
♦ A Q 6
♣ A K 7

♠ A 8 7 2
♥ J 9 2
♦ 10 9 7
♣ J 3 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♥4

EAST is right at the maximum for a 1♠ opening bid - one more point and he would have opened 2♣.

WEST does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response. She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

EAST is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.

Board 13
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 3
♥ A J 4
♦ A 10
♣ 9 6 2

♠ 7 2
♥ 10 9 8 6 2
♦ 9 8 3
♣ A J 4

♠ 5
♥ 7 3
♦ 6 5 4 2
♣ K Q 10 8 7 5

♠ A K 9 6 4
♥ K Q 5
♦ K Q J 7
♣ 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♠ by North
Lead: ♣K

NORTH has a minimum 1♠ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps. She doesn't even suspect what's about to befall!

SOUTH hears the 1♠ bid and all he wants to know is whether NORTH has one, two or three Aces. So he uses the Blackwood convention, 4NT.

NORTH has two Aces so she bids 5♥ (5♣ would show zero Aces, 5♦ would show one Ace, etc).

SOUTH has heard enough and bids 6♠.

Board 14
East Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 9 5
♥ 10 3
♦ Q J 9
♣ K Q J 8

♠ A 7 4
♥ Q 5
♦ K 7 6 4
♣ 7 6 5 3

♠ 6 2
♥ A K 8 7 6 2
♦ A 10 3
♣ A 9

♠ K J 8 3
♥ J 9 4
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 10 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
1NT	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♦2

EAST has an above-minimum strength hand with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1♥.

WEST, with 9 points, is a little too weak to bid at the 2-level so she bids a catchall 1NT.

EAST shows his 6-card suit and extra strength by jumping to 3♥, which WEST raises to 4♥ since two trumps is now adequate support.

Board 15
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 8 3 ♥ A Q 7 4 ♦ J 5 3 ♣ 7 6	
♠ 9 2 ♥ K 10 2 ♦ A 10 9 ♣ J 9 8 5 4		♠ A 6 5 ♥ J 9 6 5 ♦ K Q 8 4 ♣ 10 3
	♠ K Q 7 4 ♥ 8 3 ♦ 7 6 2 ♣ A K Q 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by South
Lead: ♠9

SOUTH has 14 points and opens her 4-card ♣ suit.

NORTH must respond, and with two 4-card Majors bids them "up-the-line", saying 1♥.

SOUTH now shows his 4-card ♠ suit, and NORTH again must bid. Since NORTH is pretty weak he just raises to 2♠, which SOUTH happily passes.

Board 16
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 6 5 3 ♥ 10 4 ♦ Q J 9 5 2 ♣ A 5 4	
♠ K Q 7 ♥ K Q J 3 ♦ A 10 6 ♣ Q 10 8		♠ A 9 4 ♥ A 7 ♦ K 8 3 ♣ K J 9 6 2
	♠ J 10 8 2 ♥ 9 8 6 5 2 ♦ 7 4 ♣ 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	4NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♦Q

WEST has a maximum 17 point 1NT bid.

EAST, with 16 points, can't tell if there are enough points for slam. If WEST has 17 points then a slam should be makeable, but if WEST has only 15 points then he should settle for game.

The 4NT raise solves the problem. It tells WEST to bid 6NT with 17 points, pass with 15 points, and use best judgment with 16. Here WEST bids the slam.

Board 17
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 8 6 2
♥ J 5 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 2

♠ J 10 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ A 8 5

♠ 5
♥ A K 10 9
♦ J 8 3 2
♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ K 9 7 3
♥ 8 4 2
♦ A K 5
♣ J 7 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
All Pass			

3♠ by North
Lead: ♥K

SOUTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when NORTH opens 1♠ SOUTH should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3♠.

NORTH has just 13 points, and knowing SOUTH has less than 13 he passes.

Board 18
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 9 6 5
♥ J 9
♦ 9 2
♣ A J 7 3 2

♠ 7 3
♥ Q 8 6 4 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ K 9 5

♠ 10 8 2
♥ A K 7 5 3
♦ K Q 5
♣ Q 6

♠ K Q J 4
♥ 10
♦ J 10 7 4 3
♣ 10 8 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♠K

After EAST opens with 1♥, WEST has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4♥ instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.

Board 19
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q J 7 5 ♥ A ♦ A K Q 3 ♣ K 10 6 2	
♠ 9 4 ♥ K Q 10 6 3 ♦ 10 4 2 ♣ A 7 4		♠ A 6 2 ♥ 9 8 5 4 ♦ J 7 5 ♣ 9 8 5
	♠ K 10 8 3 ♥ J 7 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ Q J 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

NORTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start with 1♦.

SOUTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit so he responds 1♠.

NORTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game. She bids 4♠.

Board 20
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 8 2 ♥ 10 6 3 ♦ 10 9 4 3 2 ♣ J 10 2	
♠ K Q J 7 4 ♥ K Q 2 ♦ A J 6 ♣ 9 3		♠ 10 9 6 3 ♥ 7 5 4 ♦ Q 7 ♣ A K 6 4
	♠ A 5 ♥ A J 9 8 ♦ K 8 5 ♣ Q 8 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♣J

NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

WEST has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♠ rather than 1NT. EAST isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2♠. WEST has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3♠. EAST has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4♠.

Board 21
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ K Q 5
♦ A Q J
♣ K J 4 2

♠ 7 5 2
♥ 10 7
♦ 6 5 4
♣ A 9 8 7 6

♠ A 9 6 4
♥ 9 8 4 3 2
♦ 8 7 2
♣ 3

♠ Q 10 8
♥ A J 6
♦ K 10 9 3
♣ Q 10 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	4NT
All Pass			

4NT by North
Lead: ♥8

NORTH has a perfect 2NT opening hand, 20 points and 3-3-3-4 distribution.

SOUTH, with 12 points of his own, knows the partnership is borderline strong enough for slam. Since he is happy with Notrump, he invites NORTH to bid slam by responding 4NT.

With one more point NORTH might bid the slam, but here she just passes.

Board 22
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 8 2
♥ 9 8 7 5
♦ 10 9 6 4
♣ 9 6

♠ J 10 4
♥ A J 6
♦ K 5 3
♣ 10 8 7 2

♠ 9 6 5
♥ K Q 2
♦ A 8 7
♣ K Q J 3

♠ K Q 7 3
♥ 10 4 3
♦ Q J 2
♣ A 5 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2NT			
All Pass			

2NT by East
Lead: ♥4

EAST opens 1NT with 15 points and a balanced hand.

WEST, with 9 points, cannot bid game herself, but she can invite EAST to bid game if he has the maximum 17 point opener. So she responds 2NT.

EAST doesn't have maximum, he has minimum, so he passes.

Board 23
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 2
♥ A K
♦ 7 6 4
♣ A K Q 5

♠ K
♥ Q 9 8
♦ Q 10 9 8 5 3
♣ 10 6 3

♠ A 6 4 3
♥ J 10 7 5 3
♦ 2
♣ J 9 8

♠ J 9 7 5
♥ 6 4 2
♦ A K J
♣ 7 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♠K

NORTH is 1 point too strong to open 1NT, so opens 1♣.

SOUTH responds in his 4-card Major suit, 1♠.

NORTH now shows her 4-card support plus her extra strength by jumping to 3♠ and SOUTH bids the game.

Board 24
West Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 6
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ A 8 2
♣ Q 10 6 4

♠ K Q J
♥ K Q 8
♦ Q J 9 3
♣ A K 2

♠ 5 4 3
♥ A 7 2
♦ K 10 6 5
♣ 9 8 5

♠ A 9 8 7 2
♥ 9 6 3
♦ 7 4
♣ J 7 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♥4

WEST has a classic 2NT opening bid, 21 points and balanced distribution.

EAST knows that her 7 points will be plenty for game, but not enough to consider slam so she just bids 3NT.